



BY **SUNIL MATHUR**

A New Growth Phase

The increased spending on infrastructure and private spending on new-age tech will drive this growth

INDIA'S SUCCESSFUL mission to the moon in 2023 is a reflection of its capabilities and aspirations. It is symbolic of the country's potential and resilience—bouncing back from failures and aiming for higher goals. As the world watched, India demonstrated that its advancement in home-grown technology, engineering prowess, and will to succeed in spite of challenges is second to none.

In a global environment beset with macroeconomic and geopolitical volatility, India remains a shining star and is firmly on a sustained growth path. We have enough reason to believe that it will remain so for the next five to six years and more.

It is the fastest-growing large economy. Per current projections, the GDP could cross \$7 trillion by 2030. India's economy is now the fifth-largest in the world, and it is among the Top 10 for FDI inflows. It is the third-largest host country for greenfield projects. Almost every bit of software written anywhere in the world can trace its roots back to India. Bengaluru is no longer the sole technology hub of India—six other cities and 26 Tier II cities are emerging as technology hubs.

Here are a few more reasons to cheer: Seven years since its launch, transactions through the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) crossed 10 billion for the first time in August 2023—doubling since April 2022. Within two years of its launch, the Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC) has more than 200,000 active sellers and service providers, with a network spread

across more than 500 cities and towns across India. The Unified Logistics Interface Platform, launched in 2022 as part of the National Logistics Policy, has so far integrated the systems of eight ministries. These stand as testimony to the robustness of India's digital infrastructure, a journey that got well and truly underway in 2015 with the launch of the Digital India initiative,

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